

the 1990s, the number of people in the world who are obese has increased by 100% (World Health Organization 2000). The prevalence of obesity in the United States has increased from 15% in 1980 to 25% in 1994 (Flegal et al. 1994). In the United Kingdom, the prevalence of obesity has increased from 10% in 1980 to 15% in 1994 (Roberts and Manolagas 1999). The prevalence of obesity in children has also increased in the United States (Flegal et al. 1994) and in the United Kingdom (Roberts and Manolagas 1999). The increase in the prevalence of obesity is a global phenomenon, with the highest prevalence rates found in developed countries (Flegal et al. 1994). The increase in the prevalence of obesity is a major public health problem, as obesity is a risk factor for a number of chronic diseases, including heart disease, diabetes, and certain types of cancer (World Health Organization 2000).

The increase in the prevalence of obesity is a complex phenomenon, with a number of factors contributing to the increase. One of the main factors is the increase in the consumption of high-calorie, high-fat foods (Roberts and Manolagas 1999). Another factor is the decrease in physical activity (Roberts and Manolagas 1999). The increase in the prevalence of obesity is also a result of changes in the environment, with more people living in urban areas and less access to green spaces (Roberts and Manolagas 1999). The increase in the prevalence of obesity is a global phenomenon, with the highest prevalence rates found in developed countries (Flegal et al. 1994).

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